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Routing Differences with PWA Kit

PWA Kit uses React Router 5 with programmatic route arrays and manual splitting patterns. Storefront Next uses React Router 7 file-based routing with native nested layouts, typed loaders/actions, and automatic route-level splitting. Migrating generally means converting centralized route configuration into route files and moving route data logic into exports.

Key Differences

Aspect	PWA Kit	Storefront Next
Router Version	React Router 5	React Router 7 (framework mode)
Route Definition	Programmatic (array in <code>routes.jsx</code>)	File-based (files in <code>routes/</code>)
Code Splitting	Manual via <code>@loadable/component</code>	Automatic per route file
Data Fetching	Inside components (hooks)	Outside components (<code>loader</code> / <code>clientLoader</code>)
Loading States	Manual <code>isLoading</code> flags	Declarative via Suspense
Nested Layouts	Manual component composition	Built-in via <code><Outlet /></code>
Resource Routes	Express routes in <code>ssr.js</code>	Action files (<code>action.*.tsx</code>)
Multi-Site URLs	<code>configureRoutes()</code> expansion	TBD / handled differently
Type Safety	JavaScript	TypeScript with typed loaders

Route Definition Comparison

PWA Kit:





```
5   { path: "/account/orders", component: Orders },
6 ];
```

Storefront Next:

```
src/routes/
├─ product.$productId.tsx    # /product/:productId
├─ account.tsx               # /account (layout)
├─ account._index.tsx        # /account (index)
└─ account.orders.tsx        # /account/orders
```

Navigation API Comparison

PWA Kit (React Router 5):

```
1 import { useHistory, useParams } from "react-router-dom"
2
3 const history = useHistory();
4 history.push("/cart");
5 history.replace("/new-path");
```

Storefront Next (React Router 7):

```
1 import { useNavigate, useParams } from "react-router"
2
3 const navigate = useNavigate();
4 navigate("/cart");
5 navigate("/new-path", { replace: true });
```

Key Similarities

1. Dynamic Parameters: Both use `:param` syntax (PWA Kit in path string, Storefront Next in file name with `$`).
2. Catch-All Routes: Both support wildcard routes (`*` in PWA Kit, `$.tsx` in Storefront Next).
3. Programmatic Navigation: Both provide hooks for imperative navigation.
4. Route Parameter Access: Both provide `useParams()` hook for accessing URL parameters.

Storefront Conversion Considerations

1. Route File Creation: Each route in `routes.jsx` becomes a separate file in `src/routes/`.
2. Naming Convention: Learn the flat routes naming pattern (`$` for params, `.` for nesting).

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5. Resource Routes: Convert Express API routes to `action.*.tsx` files.

6. Loading States: Replace `isLoading` checks with Suspense boundaries via `createPage`.

References

- [React Router 5 Documentation](#)
- [React Router 7 Documentation](#)
- [React Router Flat Routes](#)
- [Loadable Components](#)

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